

TDWG Technical Architecture Group (TAG)

Online Meeting — 2024-03-21

Logistics

Meeting Date and Time: 2024-03-21

Zoom Link: <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/88412244666>

Video Recording: <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1iRqeioMQ3w6eYu6tINE61NK4H7BxjlHA?usp=sharing>

TAG GitHub Repo: <https://github.com/tdwg/tag>

Attendees

- Ben Norton
- Steve Baskauf
- David Fichtmueller
- Cecilie Svenningsen
- John Kunze
- Kit Lewers

Regrets: Raïssa Meyer

Agenda

- Controlled Vocabularies
- XSD — JSON
 - XPath
 - <https://github.com/tdwg/PlinianCore>
- RDF — Deferred to April
- StaDocGen — Deferred to April

Notes

XSD and XPath Context

In XSD standards, XPaths provide context to specific terms. A term can often only be fully understood by using its XPath ancestry. Transforming an XSD standard to a traditional flattened CSV or JSON format often requires flattening the existing structure, which can cause this context to be lost. Strategies for preserving context using an additional field for XPaths and/or using URIs to document ancestors were discussed.

Several terms in Plinian Core have multiple XPaths. The flattened structure includes a repeatable XPath field, allowing terms repeated in multiple contexts to be listed once with a pipe-delimited list of XPaths documenting each instance in the XSD.

Controlled Vocabularies

TDWG has an existing process for published controlled vocabularies such as the Establishment of Means. Complex hierarchies require additional metadata beyond what is currently available in the TDWG infrastructure, including the need to reconstruct complicated hierarchies with both optional and required ranks.

John Kunze described an approach using a single master glossary from which vocabularies are constructed (a "pool of terms"). See <https://yamz.net>

GBIF is seeking guidance on an effort to publish controlled vocabularies, especially those constructed from an aggregate of existing published values.

Links

<https://dwc.tdwg.org/doi/>

<https://github.com/tdwg/rs.tdwg.org/blob/master/process/create-vocabulary.md>

<https://github.com/tdwg/PlinianCore>

<https://github.com/tdwg/abcd>

<https://tdwg.github.io/lwc/terms/index.html>

<https://mapping-commons.github.io/sssom/>

<https://www.tdwg.org/standards/status-and-categories/>

<https://github.com/tdwg/tag>